

Real Estate Website Project

Class Q&A Summary

1. Project Background

Item	Details
Instructor's role	The instructor is the project manager and team lead. He also acts as the customer and stakeholder for the project.
Client	A real estate company with about 25 years of experience. The company deals with residential real estate only, not commercial properties.
Jurisdiction	The company is licensed in New Brunswick and has worked with some clients in Nova Scotia before. Because real estate laws are different between jurisdictions, the business operates within Canada and follows the applicable provincial rules.
Sprint 1 scope	The three use cases for Sprint 1 are Create Customer, Create Agent, and Upload Image.

The instructor also mentioned that customers may not be technical, so we should explain things in a way that is easy for a non-technical person to understand.

2. Business Requirements

Q: Should we use real property listings or fake data?

A: The data should look as realistic as possible. The instructor can provide information from some previous listings if needed. We should also use our own understanding of the real estate business.

Q: What types of users will the system have?

So far, the user types mentioned are:

- Customer
- Agent
- Receptionist
- Broker
- Webmaster
- System Administrator

Different users will have different permissions. There may be other user types in later iterations.

Receptionist: An agent may visit many properties in one day and take hundreds of pictures. The

receptionist may take the pictures from the agent's phone and upload them to the system.

Broker: The broker is the person who has the legal qualifications and whose name the real estate business is licensed under. Other employees work for the broker.

Q: What can visitors see without logging in?

A: The public website should eventually allow people to see properties for sale without registering or logging in. However, the property listing feature is **not part of this iteration**.

Q: Who will use the website in this iteration?

A: For this iteration, the main users are **staff and administrators**.

Customers and agents will not log in yet. How customer and agent access will work can be decided in a later iteration.

Q: Who can create customer accounts?

A: Only staff members can create customer accounts.

There is no customer self-registration because the company needs to verify the person's age and identity. This is also important for preventing identity fraud.

Not every agent can create a customer. Administrative staff, the broker, or the system administrator can create customers.

Q: Do we need to store driver's license information?

A: There are two possible approaches:

- Store the ID information, or
- Just confirm that the person's age and identity have been checked.

Either approach is acceptable for now. The same idea applies to both customers and agents.

Q: What types of ID can be accepted?

A: The company can accept different types of photo ID, such as:

- Driver's license
- Passport
- Military ID
- Non-driver photo ID card

Receptionists will know what information they need to check.

Q: How are agent accounts created?

A: Agents cannot register themselves.

When a new agent is hired, HR or the receptionist creates the account after checking the agent's age and photo ID.

Q: What are the contact information requirements?

A: For customers:

- An email address is required.
- The first phone number is required.
- The second phone number is optional.
- Phone numbers can be international. We should not assume that every phone number has a Canadian area code.

Agents may travel or go on vacation outside Canada, but they still have Canadian addresses because they are Canadian residents.

Q: Can an agent also be a customer?

A: Yes.

For example, an agent could buy a house through the same real estate company. In that case, the person could have both an agent record and a customer record.

This probably won't be handled in Sprint 1, but we should keep this possibility in mind when designing the system.

Q: Should the website include email or other communication features?

A: No.

The website does not need to provide email or messaging. Communication can happen through regular phone numbers and email outside the system.

Q: How long does a property listing last?

A: A listing lasts **six months**. This is related to legal and contractual requirements. During this period, the customer normally cannot simply switch to another realtor.

If there is a problem between the customer and agent, the company may allow the customer to change agents.

This is outside the current iteration.

Q: Should we add features such as a map?

A: No.

The instructor said that we should focus on the basic requirements first, especially correctly identifying customers and agents and getting property content into the system.

3. Image Upload

Q: Where should uploaded images be stored?

A: The actual image files should be stored on the **server's hard drive**, not directly in the database.

The database should store information about the image, such as:

- File path
- File name
- Other information needed to identify the image

Q: What validation is required for uploaded images?

A: There are three types of validation mentioned in class:

- File size
- File type
- A third validation rule **(Business Rules 12 and 13)** .

Q: What should the default status of a new image be?

A: A newly uploaded image should **not be approved by default**.

An agent may upload 100–200 pictures from a property. Some pictures may be blurry, poor quality, or show the wrong room.

Someone needs to review the pictures and confirm that they are good enough and that the room/property information is correct.

The actual review process is not part of Sprint 1, but the database design should allow us to add it later.

Q: What happens if two agents upload images with the same filename?

Each agent has their own account and folder, but filename conflicts can still happen.

The system needs to handle duplicate filenames. For example:

- image.jpg
- image2.jpg
- image3.jpg

Files with the same name but different extensions also need to be considered.

The exact rules for handling duplicate filenames should follow the business rules provided for the project.